

## Online Predators

### Learning Objectives

- Understand who online predators are and how they target children
- Recognize warning signs of predatory behavior online
- Learn protective strategies to stay safe from online predators

### Engage (5-7 minutes)

In the village, we teach children not to take sweets from strangers. Online predators are like digital strangers who try to gain children's trust for harmful purposes. They pretend to be friendly while hiding their true intentions, like a wolf in sheep's clothing.

### Explore (10-12 minutes)

Students identify warning signs: adults asking personal questions, requesting photos, wanting to meet in person, offering gifts, or asking to keep secrets. Like recognizing suspicious behavior in unfamiliar village visitors, these signs indicate potential danger.

### Explain (10-12 minutes)

Online predators use tactics: building trust through compliments, offering gifts or game currency, asking to move to private messaging, requesting photos, and isolating children from friends and family. Like farmers protecting livestock from predators, children must recognize and avoid these dangerous tactics.

### Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Students practice safe responses: never share personal information, don't respond to suspicious messages, tell a trusted adult immediately, and never agree to meet online contacts. Like a village safety drill, practicing these responses builds protective habits.

### Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Can students identify at least three warning signs of online predators? Can they explain why adults shouldn't ask children for personal information? Do they know who to tell if they encounter suspicious online behavior?